

skills that people value enough to pay for. They add value to the lives of others.

Others acquire degrees from the same colleges. They have diplomas printed on the same paper. Yet they find themselves trapped in low-paying careers or working jobs unrelated to their field of study because the body of knowledge they developed is not highly valued by society.

Jonathan

Although I graduated with \$168,000 in student loan debt, I chose a profession that paid a six-figure salary upon entry. That wasn't an accident. It was a choice based on the economics presented to me. In retrospect, there are much easier paths to a six-figure income than my chosen path.

I find the virtually unlimited amount of money that we let teenagers take out to get any degree imaginable maddening. Going \$90,000 in debt for a job that pays \$40,000 is financial suicide. The mantra of "every kid needs to go to college" seems shallow when compared to the decades of student loan debt repayment that are tied to this decision. The decision to go to college has to be viewed through a cost-benefit analysis